

BRIDGESCALE — CONTRACTS & PAYMENTS FAQ

STATUS — SAMPLE ONLY. v0 DRAFT.

Counsel review status: NOT YET REVIEWED.

This FAQ is published for prospective Companies and Operators to understand the contractual and payments structure of a BridgeScale engagement before they commit. It is **informational** and does not modify the binding terms of the Master Service Agreement (MSA), Scope of Work (SOW), or addenda.

How to read this FAQ

The agreements that govern a BridgeScale engagement are:

- **Master Service Agreement (MSA)** — signed once between BridgeScale, the Company, and the Operator. Covers structural terms (payments, IP, conversion, non-circumvention, confidentiality). Reused for subsequent engagements between the same Company–Operator pair without re-signing.
- **Scope of Work (SOW)** — signed per engagement. Covers engagement-specific terms (scope, deliverables, term, fees, hours cap, reporting cadence, termination, special terms).
- **Addenda** — attached to the SOW where the compensation structure requires it (Hybrid Cash + Equity, Success-Fee, Equity-Only, or Conversion to full-time).
- **Pre-SOW Commercial Summary** — non-binding alignment check shared between Company and Operator after the 30-min introductory call and before the MSA is signed. Confirms the commercial shape of the engagement.

Sample versions of each are linked from the BridgeScale FAQ entries on /for-companies and /for-talent.

1. GENERAL STRUCTURE

Q: What is the Master Service Agreement (MSA)? A: A three-party legal framework signed between BridgeScale, your company, and the operator you engage. It covers payments mechanics, the platform fee, intellectual property, the full-time conversion fee, non-solicitation and non-circumvention, confidentiality, term and termination, limitation of liability, and case-study rights. It does *not* describe the work itself — that lives in the SOW.

Q: What is the Scope of Work (SOW)? A: A per-engagement document attached to the MSA as an addendum. It covers what the operator will do (scope and deliverables), how long for, at what fee, with what hours cap, how progress will be reported, and how the engagement can be terminated. The MSA stays the same across engagements; the SOW changes for each one.

Q: What is the Pre-SOW Commercial Summary? A: A non-binding one-pager BridgeScale issues to both parties after the 30-minute introductory call and before any agreement is signed. It records the commercial shape both parties have aligned on (engagement type, indicative fee, indicative term, compensation mode, special

terms). Once both parties confirm the Summary, BridgeScale generates the MSA for signature, and then the SOW is drafted from the Summary.

Q: Why three documents and not one? A: Because the structural terms (payments, IP, conversion, non-circ) should be settled once and reused. Renegotiating them every engagement is expensive and creates ambiguity. The MSA fixes those terms. The SOW only needs to capture what changes per engagement. The Pre-SOW Summary is a cheap alignment check before either party invests time in legal review.

2. USAGE & SIGNATURE

Q: Who signs the MSA? A: All three parties — BridgeScale, your company, and the operator. BridgeScale typically pre-signs the platform-side terms; your company and the operator counter-sign asynchronously through the platform.

Q: Do I sign a new MSA for every engagement? A: No. The MSA persists per Company–Operator pair. The first engagement between you and a particular operator generates a new MSA. The second, third, and subsequent engagements between the *same* Company and *same* Operator reuse the existing MSA — only the new SOW is signed. If you start an engagement with a different operator, a new MSA is generated for that pair.

Q: Who signs the SOW? A: The Company and the Operator. BridgeScale acknowledges the SOW under the parent MSA but does not sign each SOW.

Q: When is each document signed in the flow? A:

- After the 30-min introductory call, both parties indicate engagement intent on the platform.
- BridgeScale issues the **Pre-SOW Commercial Summary**.
- Both parties **confirm** the Summary.
- BridgeScale generates the **MSA** (or retrieves the existing one if a prior engagement is on file with the same operator).
- All three parties sign the MSA.
- BridgeScale drafts the **SOW** from the Summary plus the relevant service template.
- The Company and the Operator sign the SOW.
- The engagement begins; the invoice schedule starts.

Q: Can I make changes to the MSA? A: The MSA is a fixed framework intended to be reused. Material changes require BridgeScale review. Most engagement-specific deviations belong in the SOW, not the MSA.

Q: Can I make changes to the SOW? A: Yes. The SOW is the collaborative document between the Company, the Operator, and BridgeScale. Changes in scope, hours, deliverables, or fees during an active engagement are recorded as written amendments to the SOW.

3. PAYMENTS & FEES

Q: How are payments structured? A: All cash flows through BridgeScale. The Company pays BridgeScale; BridgeScale pays the Operator on the agreed cadence per the SOW.

Q: What is the BridgeScale platform fee? A: BridgeScale charges a **10% platform fee** to the Company on cash engagements. This fee is **in addition to** the Operator's stated rate; it does **not** reduce the Operator's payout. *(Placeholder rate — to be confirmed before public publication.)*

Q: Does the platform fee apply to equity? A: No. The platform fee is calculated on cash compensation only. For Hybrid Cash + Equity engagements, the 10% applies to the cash component; the equity grant is separate. For Equity-Only engagements, no platform fee applies (a small platform administration fee may apply — disclosed at SOW signing).

Q: What is the operator activation fee? A: Operators pay a one-time **USD 50** activation fee when their profile becomes eligible to be matched. The fee is paid *after* the operator completes their profile and basic tax-residency information, and the platform shows them blurred matches. Paying the activation fee unblurs the matches and lets the operator engage.

Q: What is the company unlock fee? A: Companies pay a one-time **■8,500 INR** unlock fee per match shortlist generated by BridgeScale. The fee covers the cost of the AI-powered needs diagnosis and the operator-shortlist generation. Paying the unlock fee unblurs the shortlist and lets the company request 30-min calls with selected operators.

Q: When is each side billed? A: Operator activation fee — at activation. Company unlock fee — per match shortlist. Engagement fees — per the SOW. For Sprints, typical schedule is 50% on SOW signing and 50% on Sprint completion. For Retainers, typical schedule is monthly in advance: invoice issued 5 business days before each service month begins, due on the first day of the service month.

Q: How is the Operator paid? A: Through BridgeScale's payment infrastructure, in the currency and via the rail specified in the SOW:

- ACH (United States) for US-resident Operators
- Wise (cross-border) for most non-US Operators
- Razorpay (INR direct) for Operators receiving payouts to Indian bank accounts
- Through an Employer-of-Record partner where the engagement requires it

Q: How long do payments take to clear? A: Standard ACH and equivalent corridor timing is **3–5 business days**. The SOW notes payment due dates accordingly.

Q: When is an Employer-of-Record (EOR) involved? A: When the operator's country of residence and the engagement's duration / hours / nature create employment-classification risk. Typical examples: longer-than-six-month Retainer engagements in Germany, France, the Netherlands, Spain, Ireland, Portugal, or Italy. BridgeScale's day-1 EOR partners are Deel (global default), Remote (EU primary), and Multiplier (India / APAC). The decision is made by BridgeScale at MSA generation, based on a corridor-risk check.

Q: Who pays the EOR fee? A: The Company. The EOR partner's monthly fee is **charged through to the Company at cost** as a separate line item on the Company's invoice. BridgeScale does not mark up the EOR fee or absorb it.

Q: What happens if the company hires the operator full-time? A: A **conversion fee** applies. If the Company directly hires the Operator as a full-time employee within 12 months of the end of any SOW under the MSA, the Company pays BridgeScale **25% of the Operator's first-year cash compensation**. (*Placeholder rate — to be confirmed before public publication.*) The fee is invoiced within 90 days of the Operator's full-time start date and is due within 30 days of invoice.

Q: Can the company hire the operator full-time outside BridgeScale? A: Not within the 12-month window described above. Doing so violates non-circumvention under the MSA.

4. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & CONFIDENTIALITY

Q: Who owns the work the operator produces? A: The Company, on full payment for the engagement. Deliverables created specifically for the Company under the SOW (the "Work Product") become Company property once the Operator is paid in full for the work.

Q: What about pre-existing tools and frameworks the operator brings to the engagement? A: Those remain the Operator's property. The Operator may grant the Company a non-exclusive licence to use them as part of the Work Product, but does not transfer ownership.

Q: What about IP the operator develops outside the engagement? A: Not affected by the MSA or SOW. The Operator's other engagements with other companies are theirs.

Q: How is confidential information protected? A: All parties are bound by mutual confidentiality under MSA §7. Business strategies, customer data, pricing, and proprietary materials disclosed during the engagement may only be used as needed to perform under the agreements. Confidentiality survives termination by three years.

5. NON-SOLICITATION & NON-CIRCUMVENTION

Q: Can I work directly with the operator outside BridgeScale? A: No, not for paid work, while the MSA is in effect or for 12 months after the end of the most recent SOW. This is the non-circumvention clause in MSA §6.2.

Q: What if I want to introduce the operator to my friend's company? A: That's allowed, but if your friend's company subsequently engages the operator on a paid basis, that engagement should run through BridgeScale. The operator and the new company will sign their own MSA.

Q: Can BridgeScale, the operator, or I solicit each other's clients or staff? A: No, not for 12 months after the engagement ends. This is the non-solicitation clause in MSA §6.1.

6. SOW-SPECIFIC DETAILS

Q: What's in the SOW? A: Twelve sections: engagement title; service lane and template; engagement type (Consultation / Sprint / Retainer-Leadership / Retainer-Operator); scope of services; deliverables with timeline; success metrics; term; fees and payment; compensation mode; reporting and communication; termination; special terms.

Q: What's the minimum engagement length? A: For a Sprint, 30 days. For a Retainer (either flavour), 60 days. A Consultation is a one-off session.

Q: How is a Sprint terminated? A: A Sprint runs to completion. Either party may terminate for material breach with 7 days' written notice and an opportunity to cure during the notice period. On termination, the operator is paid for all services rendered up to the termination date.

Q: How is a Retainer terminated? A: Either party may terminate the Retainer on 30 days' written notice. The operator is paid through and including the notice period. Equity components, if any, follow the vesting treatment in the Hybrid Cash + Equity or Equity-Only Addendum.

Q: How is reporting handled? A: The SOW identifies the Company's primary contact and the cadence. Default cadence: weekly call (30 min) or bi-weekly review (60 min) plus daily/weekly async updates in the agreed reporting tool (typically Slack, Notion, Linear, or email). Engagement milestones are tracked in BridgeScale's engagement workspace.

7. OTHER

Q: Can the operator publish a case study about my engagement? A: Only with your written approval. The MSA permits the Operator to name the Company and use logos in marketing materials *only* after the Company gives prior written consent (which the Company may withhold for any reason).

Q: What happens if I'm not satisfied with the operator? A: BridgeScale offers a satisfaction guarantee — if a match doesn't work out, we'll re-match you with a new operator at no additional unlock fee. The detailed mechanics of the guarantee are described in the BridgeScale Cancellation Policy.

Q: What's the cancellation policy for a 30-minute introductory call? A: For paid Consultations: full refund if the operator cancels with more than 24 hours' notice; partial refund (90%) if the company cancels with more than 24 hours' notice; 50% refund within 24 hours; no refund for company no-show. The first late-cancel by an operator is waived without penalty; subsequent late-cancels reduce the operator's next session payout.

Q: What if a corridor or scenario isn't covered by your standard combinations? A: Engagements that don't match BridgeScale's pre-approved combinations (specific role × service template × engagement type × compensation mode × operator country) route to BridgeScale's deal-desk for legal review. We aim for a 5-business-day turnaround. If we can't support the engagement, we'll tell you up-front.

Q: Where can I read the actual templates? A: Sample versions of the MSA, SOW, Pre-SOW Commercial Summary, and the four addenda are linked from the BridgeScale FAQ entries on /for-companies and /for-talent. They're marked SAMPLE while final versions are under counsel review. The templates you'll sign are the final versions.

Q: Who do I contact with questions not answered here? A: support@bridgescale.com (or the equivalent platform support contact). Your dedicated platform contact during onboarding will also handle contract questions.

DRAFTER NOTES — REMOVE BEFORE PUBLICATION

- **Tone** — kept conversational and informational; not legalistic. Counsel may want to flag specific Qs as covered-by-the-binding-document for liability reasons.
- **§3 Platform fee 10%** — placeholder. Update to founder + finance-locked rate.
- **§3 Conversion fee 25%** — placeholder. Update to founder + legal-locked rate.
- **§3 EOR partners** — Deel + Remote + Multiplier are founder-direction-locked but partner contracts still require signature (see Decision Register G1).
- **§3 ACH 3–5 business days** — payment-rail-specific. Counsel: confirm that publishing this timing creates no obligation (it's an industry standard, but explicit publication can carry weight).
- **§4 IP — full-payment trigger** — language relies on MSA §4.1; counsel should verify FAQ description aligns precisely with binding text.
- **§5 Non-circ 12 months** — placeholder window. Counsel: enforceability varies by jurisdiction (especially Indian and Californian law).
- **§6 Reporting tools** — listing Slack / Notion / Linear / email is illustrative; not a representation that BridgeScale has integrations with each.
- **§7 Satisfaction guarantee** — light reference here; full Cancellation Policy is a separate document (P0.9 + the Cancellation Policy plain-English version that lives elsewhere). Cross-reference once that document is published.
- **§7 Cancellation policy** — terms summarised; full policy lives separately.
- **§7 Corridor / deal-desk** — language refers to corridors not yet locked (Decision Register G5). Counsel: confirm "5-business-day turnaround" is a soft commitment, not an SLA.
- **Cross-document cross-references** — once final, every "MSA §X" and "SOW §X" reference must be checked for accuracy after counsel revisions.
- **Multilingual considerations** — at launch in English only. Translation strategy (if any) for Tier-2 corridors deferred to Phase 6.

End of Contracts & Payments FAQ placeholder v0 DRAFT.